TEKS explained

Grade 3 and Grade 4 | Standards used in this nine-week plan

Actual student-expectation wording is followed by a plain-English explanation. Capitalization and final punctuation are normalized; 9D(i) includes its introductory clause. These adapted tasks provide access to the standards and do not by themselves establish mastery of every part.

Reading and writing

Grade 3

TEKS 3.6G

Evaluate details read to determine key ideas.

In plain English: Decide which details matter and use them to work out the text's key ideas.

TEKS 3.7C

Use text evidence to support an appropriate response.

In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows.

TEKS 3.7D

Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order.

In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order.

TEKS 3.8A

Infer the theme of a work, distinguishing theme from topic.

In plain English: Work out the story's message, and distinguish that message from its topic.

TEKS 3.8B

Explain the relationships among the major and minor characters.

In plain English: Explain how the main and supporting characters are connected.

TEKS 3.8C

Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution.

In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved.

TEKS 3.9C

Discuss elements of drama such as characters, dialogue, setting, and acts.

In plain English: Recognize and discuss the characters, spoken lines, setting and acts in a play.

TEKS 3.9D(i)

Recognize characteristics and structures of informational text, including: the central idea with supporting evidence.

In plain English: Identify an informational text's central idea and the details that support it.

TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

In plain English: Write a response that shows you understand a story or information text.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.6G

Evaluate details read to determine key ideas.

In plain English: Decide which details matter and use them to work out the text's key ideas.

TEKS 4.7C

Use text evidence to support an appropriate response.

In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows.

TEKS 4.8A

Infer basic themes supported by text evidence.

In plain English: Work out a story's message and support it with evidence from the text.

TEKS 4.8B

Explain the interactions of the characters and the changes they undergo.

In plain English: Explain how characters affect one another and how they change during the story.

TEKS 4.8C

Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution.

In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution.

TEKS 4.9D(i)

Recognize characteristics and structures of informational text, including: the central idea with supporting evidence.

In plain English: Identify an informational text's central idea and the details that support it.

TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

In plain English: Write to show understanding, including how ideas are alike and different across texts.

Math

Grade 3

TEKS 3.3A

Represent fractions greater than zero and less than or equal to one with denominators of 2, 3, 4, 6, and 8 using concrete objects and pictorial models, including strip diagrams and number lines.

In plain English: Model fractions from greater than zero through one, using halves, thirds, fourths, sixths and eighths.

TEKS 3.3C

Explain that the unit fraction 1/b represents the quantity formed by one part of a whole that has been partitioned into b equal parts where b is a non-zero whole number.

In plain English: Explain that a unit fraction is one equal part of a whole.

TEKS 3.3D

Compose and decompose a fraction a/b with a numerator greater than zero and less than or equal to b as a sum of parts 1/b.

In plain English: Build and break apart a fraction as a sum of unit fractions.

TEKS 3.3F

Represent equivalent fractions with denominators of 2, 3, 4, 6, and 8 using a variety of objects and pictorial models, including number lines.

In plain English: Use models or number lines to show equivalent fractions.

TEKS 3.3G

Explain that two fractions are equivalent if and only if they are both represented by the same point on the number line or represent the same portion of a same size whole for an area model.

In plain English: Explain why equivalent fractions mark the same point or cover the same amount of an equal-size whole.

TEKS 3.3H

Compare two fractions having the same numerator or denominator in problems by reasoning about their sizes and justifying the conclusion using symbols, words, objects, and pictorial models.

In plain English: Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator and justify which is greater.

TEKS 3.4D

Determine the total number of objects when equally-sized groups of objects are combined or arranged in arrays up to 10 by 10.

In plain English: Find the total in equal groups or arrays up to 10 by 10.

TEKS 3.4E

Represent multiplication facts by using a variety of approaches such as repeated addition, equal-sized groups, arrays, area models, equal jumps on a number line, and skip counting.

In plain English: Show multiplication using groups, arrays, repeated addition, jumps or skip counting.

TEKS 3.4H

Determine the number of objects in each group when a set of objects is partitioned into equal shares or a set of objects is shared equally.

In plain English: Find how many objects are in each group after sharing equally.

TEKS 3.4J

Determine a quotient using the relationship between multiplication and division.

In plain English: Use a related multiplication fact to solve a division problem.

TEKS 3.5E

Represent real-world relationships using number pairs in a table and verbal descriptions.

In plain English: Use pairs of numbers in a table to describe a real-world relationship.

TEKS 3.7D

Determine when it is appropriate to use measurements of liquid volume (capacity) or weight.

In plain English: Decide whether a situation calls for measuring weight or liquid capacity.

TEKS 3.7E

Determine liquid volume (capacity) or weight using appropriate units and tools.

In plain English: Measure weight or liquid capacity with the right tool and units.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.3A

Represent a fraction a/b as a sum of fractions 1/b, where a and b are whole numbers and b > 0, including when a > b.

In plain English: Build fractions, including amounts greater than one, by adding unit fractions.

TEKS 4.3B

Decompose a fraction in more than one way into a sum of fractions with the same denominator using concrete and pictorial models and recording results with symbolic representations.

In plain English: Break a fraction into same-denominator sums in more than one way; show models and equations.

TEKS 4.3C

Determine if two given fractions are equivalent using a variety of methods.

In plain English: Determine whether two fractions name the same amount.

TEKS 4.3D

Compare two fractions with different numerators and different denominators and represent the comparison using the symbols >, =, or <.

In plain English: Compare fractions with different numerators and denominators using >, = or <.

TEKS 4.3E

Represent and solve addition and subtraction of fractions with equal denominators using objects and pictorial models that build to the number line and properties of operations.

In plain English: Model and solve fraction addition and subtraction with equal denominators.

TEKS 4.4E

Represent the quotient of up to a four-digit whole number divided by a one-digit whole number using arrays, area models, or equations.

In plain English: Model division of up to a four-digit number by a one-digit number.

TEKS 4.4F

Use strategies and algorithms, including the standard algorithm, to divide up to a four-digit dividend by a one-digit divisor.

In plain English: Use division strategies and the standard algorithm with up to four-digit dividends and one-digit divisors.

TEKS 4.5A

Represent multi-step problems involving the four operations with whole numbers using strip diagrams and equations with a letter standing for the unknown quantity.

In plain English: Represent multi-step problems using the four operations, diagrams and equations with a letter for the unknown.

TEKS 4.5B

Represent problems using an input-output table and numerical expressions to generate a number pattern that follows a given rule representing the relationship of the values in the resulting sequence and their position in the sequence.

In plain English: Use a rule, an input-output table and expressions to represent a number pattern.

TEKS 4.5C

Use models to determine the formulas for the perimeter of a rectangle (l + w + l + w or 2l + 2w), including the special form for perimeter of a square (4s) and the area of a rectangle (l x w).

In plain English: Use models to explain rectangle area and perimeter formulas.

TEKS 4.5D

Solve problems related to perimeter and area of rectangles where dimensions are whole numbers.

In plain English: Solve rectangle area and perimeter problems with whole-number side lengths.

Science

Grade 3

TEKS 3.7A

Demonstrate and describe forces acting on an object in contact or at a distance, including magnetism, gravity, and pushes and pulls.

In plain English: Show and explain pushes, pulls, gravity and magnetism, including forces that act without touching.

TEKS 3.7B

Plan and conduct a descriptive investigation to demonstrate and explain how position and motion can be changed by pushing and pulling objects such as swings, balls, and wagons.

In plain English: Plan and carry out a test showing how pushes and pulls change position or motion.

TEKS 3.8A

Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical.

In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy.

TEKS 3.8B

Plan and conduct investigations that demonstrate how the speed of an object is related to its mechanical energy.

In plain English: Plan and carry out a test connecting an object's speed to its mechanical energy.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.6B

Investigate and compare a variety of mixtures, including solutions that are composed of liquids in liquids and solids in liquids.

In plain English: Investigate and compare mixtures, including liquids mixed with liquids and solids with liquids.

TEKS 4.6C

Demonstrate that matter is conserved when mixtures such as soil and water or oil and water are formed.

In plain English: Show that matter is still present when materials are combined into a mixture.

TEKS 4.7

Plan and conduct descriptive investigations to explore the patterns of forces such as gravity, friction, or magnetism in contact or at a distance on an object.

In plain English: Plan and conduct investigations to find patterns in gravity, friction or magnetism.

TEKS 4.8A

Investigate and identify the transfer of energy by objects in motion, waves in water, and sound.

In plain English: Investigate how moving objects, water waves and sound transfer energy.

TEKS 4.8B

Identify conductors and insulators of thermal and electrical energy.

In plain English: Identify materials that let heat or electricity pass through and materials that resist it.

TEKS 4.8C

Demonstrate and describe how electrical energy travels in a closed path that can produce light and thermal energy.

In plain English: Show that electricity travels around a closed path and can produce light and heat.

Social studies

Grade 3

TEKS 3.14A

Gather information, including historical and current events and geographic data, about the community using a variety of resources.

In plain English: Gather community information from different sources, including history, current events and geography.

TEKS 3.14B

Differentiate and compare the information about a specific issue or event provided in primary and secondary sources.

In plain English: Compare what firsthand sources and later accounts say about the same issue or event.

TEKS 3.14F

Develop and communicate a claim and supporting evidence visually, orally, or in writing related to a social studies topic.

In plain English: Make a social studies claim and support it with evidence, using pictures, speech or writing.

TEKS 3.1A

Describe how individuals, events, and ideas have changed communities, past and present.

In plain English: Explain how people, events and ideas have changed communities.

TEKS 3.2B

Compare ways in which people in the local community and other communities meet their needs for government, education, communication, transportation, and recreation.

In plain English: Compare how communities meet needs such as government, education, transportation and recreation.

TEKS 3.9A

Identify characteristics of good citizenship, including truthfulness, justice, equality, respect for oneself and others, responsibility in daily life, and participation in government by educating oneself about the issues, respectfully holding public officials to their word, and voting.

In plain English: Recognize responsible citizenship, including honesty, fairness, respect and participation in government.

TEKS 3.9C

Identify and describe individual acts of civic responsibility, including obeying laws, serving and improving the community, serving on a jury, and voting.

In plain English: Describe civic responsibilities such as following laws, helping the community, jury service and voting.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.2A

Summarize motivations for European exploration and settlement of Texas, including economic opportunity, competition, and the desire for expansion.

In plain English: Explain why Europeans explored and settled Texas, including opportunity, competition and expansion.

TEKS 4.2B

Identify the accomplishments and explain the impact of significant explorers, including Cabeza de Vaca; Francisco Coronado; and René Robert Cavelier, Sieur de la Salle, on the settlement of Texas.

In plain English: Explain named explorers' accomplishments and their effects on Texas settlement.

TEKS 4.3A

Analyze the causes, major events, and effects of the Texas Revolution, including the Battle of the Alamo, the Texas Declaration of Independence, the Runaway Scrape, and the Battle of San Jacinto.

In plain English: Explain causes, major events and effects of the Texas Revolution.

TEKS 4.3B

Summarize the significant contributions of individuals such as William B. Travis, James Bowie, David Crockett, Juan N. Seguín, Plácido Benavides, José Francisco Ruiz, Antonio López de Santa Anna, Susanna Dickinson, and Enrique Esparza.

In plain English: Explain how important individuals contributed to the Texas Revolution.

TEKS 4.3C

Identify leaders important to the founding of Texas as a republic and state, including José Antonio Navarro, Sam Houston, Mirabeau Lamar, and Anson Jones.

In plain English: Identify leaders who helped establish Texas as a republic and a state.

TEKS 4.3D

Describe the successes, problems, and organizations of the Republic of Texas such as the establishment of a constitution, economic struggles, relations with American Indians, and the Texas Rangers.

In plain English: Describe the Republic of Texas's successes, problems and organizations.

TEKS 4.3E

Explain the events that led to the annexation of Texas to the United States and the impact of the U.S.-Mexican War.

In plain English: Explain how Texas became part of the United States and the effects of the U.S.-Mexican War.

Authoritative sources, checked October 12, 2026

Texas Education Agency, grade-level TEKS, revised June 2024. Grade 3: https://tea.texas.gov/curriculum-and-instruction/curriculum-standards/grade3-teks-062024.pdf Grade 4: https://tea.texas.gov/curriculum-and-instruction/curriculum-standards/grade4-teks-062024.pdf